[LIT-PLAY-003] Asang Eina Aton

Translation: Ashang and Aton: Landmark Folk Drama

Work Type: PLAY | Creator: Khenjonglang & Zingko Arts / S. Tha | Year: 2005
Village: Tongou | Dialect: Tongou / Phungcham / Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: None
Publisher / Source: National School of Drama Extension & Khenjonglang,
Clearance: Community Authorized | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Tragic romantic drama (*Khararchan-Leikashi*) - the Tangkhul 'Romeo and Juliet', Customary clan rivalries between Tongou and Phungcham

Structure & Meter: Full-length verse drama in three acts with choral odes, antiphonal dia

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Critical Overview: Widely celebrated as the first major full-length
Tangkhul folk play. Produced under the direction of S. Thaninleima

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

SHONGZA KHARAR / ACT I, SCENE 1 - TONGOU & PHUNGCHAM RAM
ASANG: (Kaphung yarsho-li kachamda) I-leishatnao Aton, Phungcham wui won

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

PROLOGUE & ACT I, SCENE 1 - TONGOU AND PHUNGCHAM VILLAGES
ASHANG: (Gazing across the alpine terraced slopes) O my beloved Aton, li

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Asang / Ashang : Hero of the tragic romance, noble warrior from Ton
* Aton / Maitonphi : Heroine of the epic romance, symbol of female grac
* Shongza kharar : Ancestral village boundary / dramatic act partitio

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